

# Marine Mammal Monitoring Report – August 2026

## Harrow Bay Offshore Wind · construction phase

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Prepared for Weyland Energy by Marlow Ecology Ltd, Bristol. Author: Dr. Rachel Moss, Principal Ecologist. Report MAR-HB-MM-2026-08.

### 1. Summary

This report covers marine mammal monitoring during August 2026, the first month of piling after the seasonal restriction. Two monopiles (HB-A11 on 6 August and HB-A12 on 23 August) were installed. The Marine Mammal Mitigation Protocol was applied in full and no marine mammal was recorded inside the 750 m mitigation zone at the start of the soft start.

The dominant species recorded was the **harbour porpoise** (*Phocoena phocoena*), followed by grey seal and a single minke whale sighting on 12 August, 6 km north of the site. Detection rates of harbour porpoise at the 750 m station dropped by around 40 % during piling days and recovered to baseline levels within 24 to 36 hours after the end of piling, which is consistent with results from other North Sea projects using double bubble curtains.

### 2. Monitoring effort

| Method                                   | Effort August 2026                    |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Visual observation (MMO, dedicated)      | 64 h over 9 days                      |
| Passive acoustic monitoring (4 stations) | 2,976 station-hours, 99.2 % uptime    |
| Aerial digital survey                    | 1 survey (19 August), 12 transects    |
| Pre-piling searches                      | 2 × 30 min, plus 1 × 20 min extension |

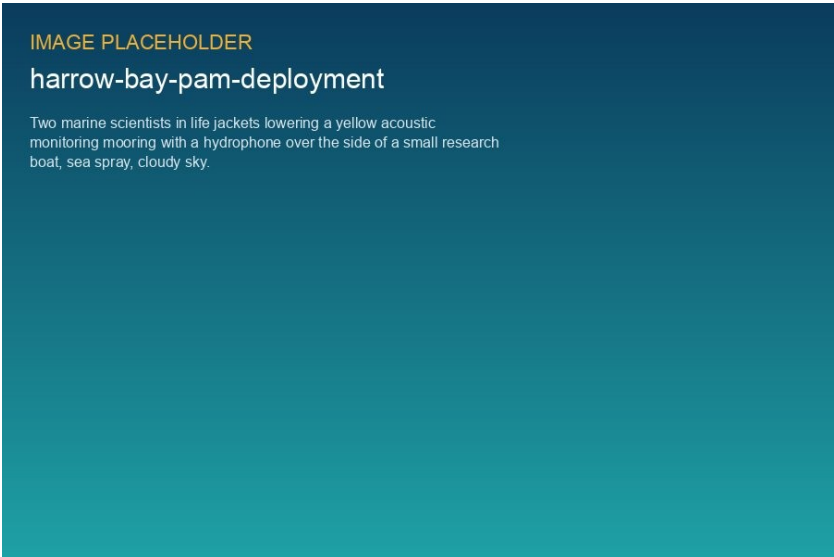
### 3. Sightings and detections

| Species              | Visual sightings | Individuals | Closest approach to pile              |
|----------------------|------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------|
| Harbour porpoise     | 17               | 31          | 420 m (before ADD activation, HB-A12) |
| Grey seal            | 6                | 7           | 1.1 km                                |
| Harbour seal         | 1                | 1           | 2.4 km                                |
| Minke whale          | 1                | 1           | 6.0 km                                |
| White-beaked dolphin | 0                | 0           | –                                     |



*Porpoise surfacing 1.8 km east of HB-A12, 22 August 2026 (photo: Marlow Ecology)*

4. Acoustic monitoring



*Redeployment of PAM station HB-PAM-03 after the July service visit*

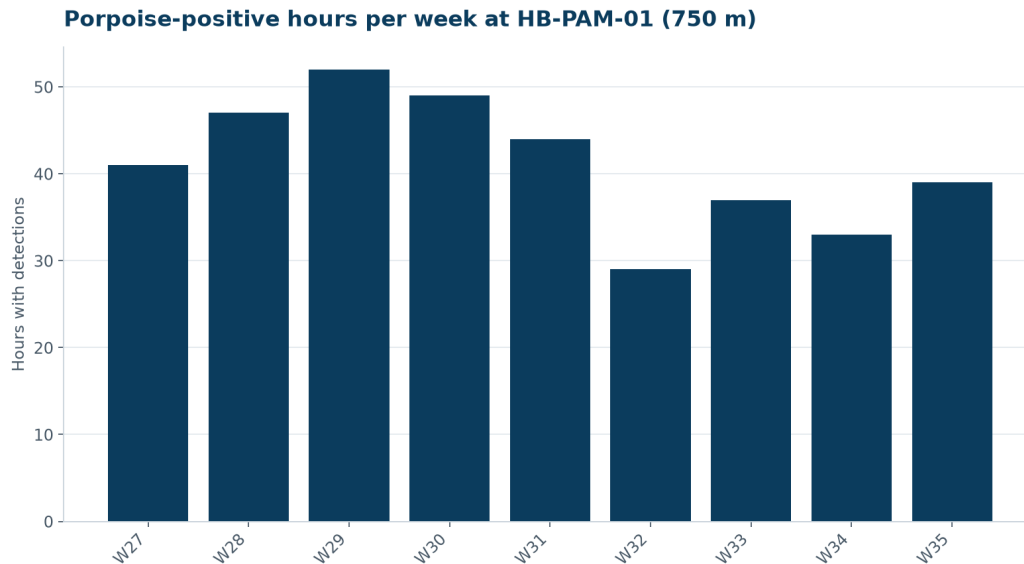


Figure 2 – Detection-positive hours per week at station HB-PAM-01

Weeks 28 to 31 represent the no-piling reference during the July restriction. In week 32 (HB-A11) detections fell to 29 hours, recovering to 37 hours in week 33. The pattern in week 34 (HB-A12 and the offshore substation topside lift) is similar.

## 5. Mitigation actions

| Date   | Pile   | Event                                             | Action                                                     |
|--------|--------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 06 Aug | HB-A11 | Search clear                                      | Soft start 07:40 as planned                                |
| 23 Aug | HB-A12 | Harbour porpoise group (3) at 420 m during search | Search extended by 20 min; ADD activated; soft start 06:55 |

## 6. Compliance and recommendations

- All requirements of the Marine Mammal Mitigation Protocol were met in August 2026.
- Noise levels at 750 m remained below 160 dB SEL for both piles (158.6 and 159.1 dB).
- Recommendation: with the planned move to 24/7 piling, night-time searches should rely on PAM with an extended 40-minute search period.
- Recommendation: continue the fourth PAM station at 1,500 m north to cover the transit corridor of the jack-up.